

VERSION	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER	APPROVED BY
1.0			Principal / Key Management Personnel	Governing body

A Complaint Manager or Incident Manager (internal or external) must be impartial and free of actual or apprehended bias. The test for apprehended bias is whether a fair-minded observer might reasonably suspect the manager is not impartial.

- has a conflict of interest or personal stake in the matter, or a relationship with one of the parties that casts doubt on the appearance of fairness;
- has displayed hostility or favouritism toward one of the parties;
- has made comments suggesting they have prejudged a disputed issue and will not approach the evidence with an open mind; or
- was involved at an earlier stage — for example in making the allegation or providing a statement in support of a party.

It is good practice to clarify bias and conflict-of-interest concerns before the process begins. Once informed of a potential issue, the parties may waive any objection and allow the manager to continue. A manager should not be chosen or withdrawn merely because a party raises a bias objection.